

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Systems of two linear equations in two variables	Easy

Question

A dance teacher ordered outfits for students for a dance recital. Outfits for boys cost \$26, and outfits for girls cost \$35. The dance teacher ordered a total of 28 outfits and spent \$881. If b represents the number of outfits the dance teacher ordered for boys and g represents the number of outfits the dance teacher ordered for girls, which of the following systems of equations can be solved to find b and g ?

Answer

- A. $26b + 35g = 28$
 $b + g = 881$
- B. $26b + 35g = 881$
 $b + g = 28$
- C. $26g + 35b = 28$
 $b + g = 881$
- D. $26g + 35b = 881$
 $b + g = 28$

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. Outfits for boys cost \$26 each and the teacher ordered b outfits for boys, so the teacher spent $26b$ dollars on outfits for boys. Similarly, outfits for girls cost \$35 each and the teacher ordered g outfits for girls, so the teacher spent $35g$ dollars on outfits for girls. Since the teacher spent a total of \$881 on outfits for boys and girls, the equation $26b + 35g = 881$ must be true. And since the teacher ordered a total of 28 outfits, the equation $b + g = 28$ must also be true.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from switching the constraint on the total number of outfits with the constraint on the cost of the outfits. Choice C is incorrect and may result from switching the constraint on the total number of outfits with the constraint on the cost of the outfits, as well as switching the cost of the outfits for boys with the cost of the outfits for girls. Choice D is incorrect and may result from switching the cost of the outfits for boys with the cost of the outfits for girls.